

5-Minute Calm

A simple, do-anywhere reset for body and mind.

When the day feels loud, you don't need an hour — five quiet minutes of conscious breath can settle the nervous system and clear the mind. Sit comfortably, tall but relaxed, and move gently through the steps below. Breathe through the nose throughout.

1

SETTLE · 30 seconds**Arrive**

Sit tall, soften your shoulders and jaw, close your eyes. Simply notice the breath as it is — no need to change it yet.

2

EXTEND THE EXHALE · 2 minutes**Breathe in for 4, out for 6**

Inhale gently for a count of four; exhale slowly for a count of six. A longer, smooth exhale is one of the fastest ways to calm the body. Keep it easy — never strain.

3

NADI SHODHANA · 1.5 minutes**A taste of the balancing breath**

Right thumb and ring finger: close the right nostril, inhale through the left; close the left, release the right, exhale right. Inhale right, then switch and exhale left. Continue slowly and evenly. (Skip if your nose is blocked.)

4

REST · 1 minute**Let it land**

Release the hand. Let the breath return to normal and rest in the quiet you've created. Notice how you feel. A small, soft smile.

Why it works: slowing the breath to around six cycles a minute — especially with a longer exhale — gently shifts you toward the body's "rest and restore" (parasympathetic) state, associated with lower stress and a steadier mind. (*Zaccaro et al., 2018, Frontiers in Human Neuroscience.*)

Want to go deeper? Learn the full Nadi Shodhana — The Healing Breath at a complimentary live workshop, and get the Yogic Breathing Guide at ashishanant.com.

This is a general wellbeing practice, not medical advice. If you are pregnant, or have a heart, respiratory or blood-pressure condition, please consult your doctor first. Come out of any practice that causes dizziness or discomfort.